



CONTINGENCY LESSONS

Reading for SylvanSync™

Elementary



GRADES 3-5

TO BE USED ONLY IN CASE OF EMERGENCY, WITH THE APPROVAL OF TECHNOLOGY SERVICES.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

VersaTiles: Long and Short Vowels

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- discriminate among long and short vowel words.
- use knowledge of letter patterns and context.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Unlock Words* book (VT3UW)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will be spelling words with short and long vowel sounds. When you answer questions correctly with VersaTiles, you will know because the uppercase letters in the corner will be in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Long and Short Vowels

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 1 in *VersaTiles: Unlock Words*. Choose the word shown in color that makes the best sense. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Unlock Words*. Read the first word in each row. Choose the word with the same vowel sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 3 in *Unlock Words*. Read the first word in each row. Choose the word with a different vowel sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 4 in *VersaTiles: Unlock Words*. Read each group of words. Choose the word in each group that has a different vowel sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 5

Go to page 5 in *VersaTiles: Unlock Words*. For numbers 1–6, read each group of words. Choose the word that has the same vowel sound that you hear in the word *no*. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly. For numbers 7–12, choose the word that has the vowel sound that you hear in the word *not*. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

VersaTiles: Spelling

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- spell words using picture clues.
- discriminate between spellings of short vowel sounds.
- proofread and correct spellings of words.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling* book (VT3KS)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will be correctly spelling words. When you answer questions correctly with VersaTiles, you will know because the uppercase letters in the corner will be in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Spelling

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 1 in *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling*. Say each picture name. Find the first or last letter to spell each word. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling*. Say each picture name. Find the letters to spell each word. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 4 in *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling*. Choose the word that solves each riddle. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 5 in *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling*. Each word is spelled incorrectly. Look at the letter(s) in color. Choose the letter or letters to replace them so that each word is spelled correctly. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 5

Go to page 6 in *VersaTiles: Keys to Spelling*. Read each clue. Find the word in the puzzle that fits each clue. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Sequence and Inferences

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- place sentences and events in sequential order.
- make inferences.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Reading and Understanding* book (VT4RU)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about spelling, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will practice placing events in sequential order and making inferences of. When you answer questions correctly with VersaTiles, you will know because the uppercase letters in the corner will be in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Sequence and Inferences

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 1 in *VersaTiles: Reading and Understanding*. Order the pictures from first to last. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Reading and Understanding*. Order the sentences so that the paragraphs make sense. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to pages 6–7 in *VersaTiles: Reading and Understanding*. Read the story on page 6. Think about the order in which things happen. Then order the events as they appeared. Use tiles 1–6. Then read the story on page 7. Order the events as they happened in the story. Use tiles 7–12. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 20 in *VersaTiles: Reading and Understanding*. Read the riddles. Find the word that solves each riddle. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

VersaTiles: Prefixes and Suffixes

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- identify prefixes and suffixes.
- discriminate between prefixes and suffixes.
- use context clues.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Build Vocabulary* book (VT4VB)
- *VersaTiles: Word Tools* book (VT4WT)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will practice identifying prefixes and suffixes and using context clues. When you answer questions correctly with VersaTiles, you will know because the uppercase letters in the corner will be in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Prefixes and Suffixes

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 1 in *VersaTiles: Build Vocabulary*. Reach each sentence. Find the prefix that makes sense. Flip over the box to see if you chose correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Build Vocabulary*. Reach each sentence. Find the suffix that makes sense. Flip over the box to see if you chose correctly.

Part 3

Go to pages 3 in *VersaTiles: Build Vocabulary*. Choose the word that has a prefix for numbers 1–6. Choose the word that has a suffix for numbers 7–12. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 5 in *VersaTiles: Word Tools*. For numbers 1–6, read each group of words. Choose the word in which an ending has been added. For numbers 7–12, read each group of words. Choose the word in which an ending has NOT been added. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 5

Go to page 6 in *VersaTiles: Word Tools*. Read each sentence. Choose the correct prefix to complete each underlined word. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Predictions and Cause and Effect

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- make inferences and use context to predict outcomes.
- identify and infer cause and effect relationships.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Discover Meaning* book (VT5DM)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will make predictions and identify cause and effect relationships in the stories and articles you read. When you answer questions correctly with VersaTiles, you will know because the uppercase letters in the corner will be in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
VersaTiles: Predictions and Cause and Effect

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 6 in *VersaTiles: Discover Meaning*. Look for clues to make predictions about the story. Find the phrase that tells what might have happened next. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 3 in *VersaTiles: Discover Meaning*. Read each group of sentences. Find the sentences that tells what happened before. Then find the sentence that tells what happened after. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 13 in *VersaTiles: Discover Meaning*. What's the most logical effect? Flip over the box to see if you answered correctly.

Part 4

Go to pages 14–15 in *VersaTiles: Discover Meaning*. Is the underlined sentence a cause or an effect? Flip over the box to see if you answered correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Story Summary 1

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- five index cards (or blank paper)
- pens or pencils

Background Information

Realistic fiction is a fictional story about something that could happen in real life. The story isn't actually true, but it seems as though it could be.

When you write a **summary** about a fictional story, you should retell the important parts of the story in your own words. State the **main idea** of the story, and two or three important **details** about the events in the story.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the story with which you might not be familiar. Then read the story, which is an example of realistic fiction. Finally, write a summary of the story and review your flash cards.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Story Summary 1

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the story.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
 2. Write one of the words below.
 3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
- **convince** (v) to make someone sure of something
 - **strain** (v) to work very hard at something
 - **envision** (v) to form a mental picture of
 - **unconsciously** (adv) to do something without meaning to
 - **declare** (v) to state something in a simple but strong way

Write three sentences using the five words above. At least two sentences will need to have two vocabulary words.

Part 2

Read the story below.

Nighttime Frights

Aiden pulled the bed covers more tightly over his head, convinced he heard a sound. Maybe it was something unspeakable hiding in his closet or a robber waiting outside his window. He strained to listen, but heard only silence and the pounding of his heart, his pulse rising as his hands became clammy with nervous sweat.

"I should go tell Mom and Dad," Aiden said to himself, but then he envisioned massive hands or slimy tentacles stretching out from under his bed, grabbing his ankles. What he really wanted to do was scream. Almost unconsciously, Aiden let out a small whimper of despair.

"Aiden?" The kind voice of his older sister, Katrina, interrupted his horrified thoughts from the bedroom door. "Aiden, what are you doing?" she asked him.

Aiden popped his head out from under the covers. "I heard something!" he declared in terror.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Story Summary 1

"Let me guess," Katrina replied, laughing lightly, "In your closet? Or under your bed?"

Aiden nodded.

"Well, don't worry too much about it," Katrina continued as she sat on the edge of her brother's bed. "Believe it or not, I know the perfect solution!" Aiden looked hopefully at Katrina. "Knock, knock," his sister started a joke.

"Who's there?" Aiden asked in return.

"Dwayne."

"Dwayne who?"

"Dwayne the bath tub! I'm dwowning!"

Aiden erupted into a fit of giggles. He then told Katrina a joke he heard at school that day. The two went back and forth until Aiden was finally feeling better and no longer scared of what might be in his closet, outside his window, or under his bed.

"See?" Katrina explained, "Whenever you're feeling frightened, just think of happy, funny thoughts. It works every time!"

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Story Summary 1

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this story?
 - a. Aiden's sister is helpful and nice.
 - b. Aiden is scared of something under his bed.
 - c. Aiden wants to call for his parents, but is too scared.
 - d. Aiden's sister helps him overcome his fear and get to bed.
2. What are some important details from the story?
3. In your own words, summarize this story.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- five index cards (or blank paper)
- pens or pencils

Background Information

A **folktale** is a traditional narrative that is told aloud, from generation to generation. The author or original teller of a folktale is rarely known.

When you write a **summary** about a folktale, you should retell the story in your own words. State the **main idea** of the story, and two or three important **details** that describe the characters and events in the story.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the story with which you might not be familiar. Then read the story, which is an example of a folktale. Finally, write a summary of the story and review your flash cards.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the story.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
 2. Write one of the words below.
 3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
- **advice** (n) someone's opinion about what another person should do
 - **condition** (n) the state of a person's existence, health, or living quarters
 - **improve** (v) to make something better
 - **scrawny** (adj) unhealthily thin and bony
 - **seriously** (adv) in a thoughtful way, without being lighthearted

Write three sentences using the five words above. At least two sentences will need to have two vocabulary words.

Part 2

Read the folktale below.

It Could Always Be Worse

A poor man had trouble at home, so he went to a wise man for advice.

"Wise Man, things are so bad!" he cried. "We are so poor that my wife, my six children, my in-laws, and I must live in a one-room hut. We get in each other's way and argue all the time. Believe me, my home is terrible, and I cannot continue living this way!"

The wise man thought seriously and said, "My son, promise to do as I tell you, and your condition will improve."

"I promise, Wise Man," answered the troubled man.

"Tell me, what animals do you own?" asked the wise man.

"I only have a skinny cow, a smelly goat, and some scrawny chickens," stated the poor man.

The wise man advised, "Go home now and take your chickens into your house to live with you."

Reading for SylvanSync™

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Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

The poor man was shocked, but he went home and brought his scrawny chickens into the house.

The following day, the poor man returned to the wise man and cried, "Wise Man, I did as you told me and brought the chickens into the house, but now things are worse than ever! Now, in addition to the noise and arguments, there is clucking and squawking all day and night! There are feathers in the soup! It is terrible!"

"My son," said the wise man quietly, "go home and bring your goat into your house."

So, the poor man ran home to bring in his smelly goat, but it was not long before he came to see the wise man again.

"Wise Man," he wailed, "there is shouting, clucking, arguing, feathers in the food, and now, the goat is smashing everything in the house! My wife says the house smells like a barnyard! Life in my home can't be worse!"

"Go home," said the wise man gently, "and bring your cow to live in your house."

The poor man sighed, returned home, and brought his skinny cow into his tiny house. But he went to see the wise man a few days later and said, "Wise Man, now my life is just awful! It couldn't be worse! There is arguing, shouting, clucking, butting, flying feathers, and it stinks! And now, the hungry cow is eating all of our food!"

"Ah," said the wise man. "Go home, and take all of the animals out of your house."

The poor man hurried home and brought all of the animals out of his tiny home.

Not a day had passed before the man came running again to the wise man. He said, "Wise Man, you have made my life sweet for me again. With all of the animals out, the house is so quiet, so roomy, and so clean! What a pleasure!"

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this story?
2. The wise man asked the poor man to live with his animals.
a. true b. false
3. The poor man learned the lesson the wise man wanted to teach.
a. true b. false
4. In your own words, summarize this story.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- three index cards (or blank paper)
- pens or pencils

Background Information

A **nonfiction article** is a short narrative about real people, places, objects, or events. You would read nonfiction articles in newspapers or magazines.

When you write a **summary** about a nonfiction article, you should retell the article in your own words by stating the **main idea** and two or three important **facts** from the article.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the article with which you might not be familiar. Then read the article. It is an example of nonfiction. Finally, write a summary of the article and review your flash cards.

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the article.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
 2. Write one of the words below.
 3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
- **improvise** (v) to compose a play, song, or piece of music without any preparations beforehand
 - **chords** (n) two or more musical notes played together
 - **rhythm** (n) the regular pattern of beats in a piece of music

Write three sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 2

Read the article below.

The Story of Jazz

Jazz is a type of music. African Americans first played it in the early 1900s. Most jazz was played in small dance bands. Bands played at picnics and weddings. They also played in parades.

The sound of jazz is a lot like African American folk music and blues music. There are many instruments used in a jazz band. Rhythm comes from drums, the piano, string bass, and a guitar. Saxophones, trombones, and trumpets add to the jazz sound.

Jazz musicians like to improvise, or make up the music as they play. They play the same basic chords over and over. Each member of the band gets to take a turn at showing his or her talent.

Many jazz bands started to play together in the 1920s. This led to many dance styles, such as swing. Forty years later, jazz started to die out. Rock and roll was new. Jazz became popular again in the 1980s. Musicians kept coming up with new sounds. Jazz is still enjoyed by people of all ages.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Now answer these questions.

1. Choose the main idea of the article and write it on your paper.
 - a. Jazz musicians like to improvise.
 - b. Jazz music is similar to blues music.
 - c. Jazz music started in the early 1900s.
 - d. Jazz music has a very interesting history and is still popular today.
2. Jazz music was first played by African Americans.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. When rock and roll became popular, jazz music died forever.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. In your own words, summarize this article.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- three index cards (or blank paper)
- pens or pencils

Background Information

A **nonfiction article** is a short narrative about real people, places, objects, or events. You would read nonfiction articles in newspapers or magazines.

When you write a **summary** about a nonfiction article, you should retell the article in your own words by stating the **main idea** and two or three important **facts** from the article.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the article with which you might not be familiar. Then read the article. It is an example of nonfiction. Finally, write a summary of the article and review your flash cards.

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the article.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
 2. Write one of the words below.
 3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
- **nucleus** (n) the central part of a comet, made of ice, frozen gas, and dust
 - **coma** (n) a bright cloud of gas and dust that surrounds the nucleus of a comet
 - **orbit** (v) to move around something, such as the Sun, in a clear path controlled by the force of gravity

Write three sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 2

Read the article below.

Comets!

When people first saw comets long ago, they described them as balls of fire with glowing tails moving across the night sky. The name comet means "hairy star."

A comet is a huge ball of frozen rock, gas, and dust. It is something like a dirty snowball. A comet has three parts. The first part is its nucleus, or center. The center is made of ice, dust, and rock. The second part is called the coma. The coma looks like a fuzzy, glowing ball of gas around the center of the comet. The third part is the tail. It can be millions of miles long!

Edmund Halley was an astronomer who studied comets. He found that comets orbit, or move in a path, around the sun. He found a comet that orbited the sun every 76 years. This comet was named after him. It is called Halley's Comet, and it will fly by again in the year 2062.

Astronomers believe there could be 100 billion comets orbiting the sun. They do not last forever though. A comet loses a lot of its size every time it passes by the sun. The heat of the sun turns the ice into gas.

Look up. One night you might be able to see a hairy star fly across the night sky.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of the article?
 - a. Comets orbit the sun.
 - b. Comets are like dirty snowballs.
 - c. Edmund Halley discovered the first comet.
 - d. Comets are interesting features of the night sky.
2. Comets are made of snow.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. Halley's comet will next appear over the earth in 2062.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. In your own words, summarize this article.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Drama

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- describe the features and functions of the elements of a play.
- read a play part "in character," using expressive oral reading.
- write an additional scene for a play.

Materials

- lined paper
- pens or pencils

Background Information

A **play** or **drama** is a story much like any other. It has a plot, setting, and characters. The main difference is that the entire story is told through **dialogue**. Dialogue is conversation. In a play, each character speaks lines that tell the story through a conversation.

In order to understand a play, you have to think about how the characters, setting, and plot of the story come through the words the characters speak.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Drama

Activity

First, read the play in this lesson quietly to yourself. Then, read the play aloud. Try to use read with expression, the way the characters might actually sound. Then complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Read the play quietly to yourself one or two times.

Scene II from *Goldilocks and the Three Bears:*
The Bear Family in the Wood

adapted from *Dramatic Reader for Lower Grades*
by Florence Holbrook

Father Bear: Well, Sonny, aren't you about ready to go home?

Sonny Bear: Oh, no, Father! Let me play just a little longer.

Mother Bear: No, dear Sonny, we must go home now. It is getting late. It's time for you to have your supper and go to bed.

Sonny Bear: All right, Mother. I am hungry, and your porridge is always so good.

Mother Bear: Most children like porridge. Perhaps you can have a nice red apple, too.

Sonny Bear: Oh, goody! Little bears always like apples, don't they, Papa?

Father Bear: Yes. Mother, let me take your knitting basket. What are you making now?

Mother Bear: A warm cap for Sonny. Isn't it pretty?

Father Bear: Very pretty, and he should be very glad he has such a good mother.

Sonny Bear: She is a good mother, and you are a very good father, too.

Father Bear: Well, here we are at home again. But the door is open. I'm certain I closed it when we went away. Who has been here?

Mother Bear: Let us take off our jackets and have our tea.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Drama

Father Bear: Hey! Somebody has been tasting my porridge!

Mother Bear: What? Let me see! Someone has left a spoon in my porridge, too.

Sonny Bear: Oh, Mama! Look at my bowl! Someone has eaten my porridge all up.

Mother Bear: Never mind, Sonny, you may have some of mine. But I wonder who has been here. Let us go into the parlor and see if anyone is there.

Father Bear: Who's been moving my chair?

Mother Bear: Someone has been sitting in my chair!

Sonny Bear: Look, Mother! Someone has been rocking in my chair and broken it all to pieces! Oh dear! My nice little chair!

Father Bear: Oh Sonny, don't cry. I'll buy you another chair at Mr. Wolf's store tomorrow.

Mother Bear: And now it is time for us to go to bed. Our little son is tired and sleepy.

Father Bear: I'll carry him up stairs. Come, Sonny, there you are up on my shoulder.

(Father Bear carries Sonny Bear up the stairs to the bedroom.)

Well, who's been in my bed, I'd like to know?

Mother Bear: Why, look at my bed. Someone has been lying on my bed!

Sonny Bear: Come quick, Mother! Father, come! Someone is in my bed.

Goldilocks: *(Waking and frightened)* Aaaaaah!!! Three Bears! I will run away! *(Runs away.)*

Mother Bear: The little girl has gone, dear. Now you must go to sleep.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Drama

Part 2

Answer some questions about the play on a separate sheet of paper.

1. Who are the characters in this play? How can you tell?
2. Why are some words in brackets like these ()?
3. Sonny Bear is a young bear.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. Goldilocks runs away at the end of the scene.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. How do you think the Bear Family feels at the end of the scene?

Part 3

If possible, form a group of three to four people. If there are only three, one person can play two parts. The part of Goldilocks only has one line.

Read the play aloud, each person speaking his or her role. Now, read it aloud again, this time making sure to use emotion in your voices as you do.

Part 4

On a separate sheet of paper, write another scene from this play. You could write the scene before this one in the woods, or the next scene, after Goldilocks leaves. You could even write the scene of what happened when Goldilocks was in the house. How many characters would be talking in that scene?

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Poem

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- identify the figurative language and sensory details in a poem.
- analyze the meaning of a poem.
- write a poem.

Materials

- lined paper
- pens or pencils

Background Information

The term **figurative language** describes language that helps readers use their senses to understand literature. Some types of figurative language are: metaphors, similes, personification, and hyperbole. These techniques paint a picture in the reader's head. They provide **sensory details** that help the reader see, feel, or smell what is being described in a poem or story.

Figurative language is often used in poetry. A **poem** is a piece of writing somewhat like a song. Poems often have rhythm and they sometimes rhyme. They are written in verse, or short lines.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Poem

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, read the poem. Then review the different types of figurative language you might see in a poem or story. Next, discover the poem's meaning by writing about it. Finally, write your own poem using figurative language that you have learned about here.

Part 1

Read the poem.

The Orchestra

By Ronda Angel

Harp plinks bright notes;
Flute twitters a tune.
The boom of drums does not drown out
The bellows of bassoon.

Viola chirps like a bird
Violin cries, zin zone!
The cymbals crash like a lightning flash,
Egging on the slide trombone.

Tuba belches deep and low,
while bass gives off sad moans.
Trumpet tries to cheer with its blasts
of bold and strident tones.
The voices of the orchestra
ring and roar and swing,
but ever do we love them most
When together they do sing.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Poem

Part 2

Review the definitions of some types of figurative language. On your paper, write an example of each from the poem above.

Alliteration The repetition of consonant sounds in two or more words or syllables.

Assonance A similarity of vowel sound in words or syllables

Onomatopoeia The naming of a sound by imitating the sound it makes.

Personification Giving human qualities to something that is not alive.

Simile The comparison of two different objects using the words *like* or *as*.

Now answer these questions.

1. Write a few sentences about how figurative language in the poem affected you. Did it help you see or hear the event described?
2. What is the meaning of this poem? Use your own words to summarize the poem.

Part 3

On your paper, brainstorm some ideas for a poem. Think about ways you could use figurative language to describe something you have seen, observed, or felt.

Now, on your sheet of paper, write a poem. Make sure to use figurative language to help your reader sense what you are describing in the poem. You want your reader to hear, feel, smell, or see the topic or event you write about.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Science Fiction

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- Identify the features of science fiction.
- Write a science fiction story.

Materials

- lined paper
- pens or pencils

Background Information

Science fiction is a fictional story that takes place in another place and time. The setting is often defined by scientific advances, such as time travel, life from outer space, or human life on other planets. The setting of most science fiction includes major social and environmental differences compared to life as we know it today.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, read the story in this lesson and answer the questions that follow. Then, plan and write your own piece of science fiction.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Science Fiction

Part 1

Read the story below.

adapted from **The Cylinder Opens**
by H.G. Wells

When I came back to the park the sun was setting. Some people were hurrying away from the pit, and one or two people were returning. The crowd around the pit had grown. There were now a couple of hundred people, perhaps. There was some yelling and there appeared to be a struggle going on. I couldn't imagine what was happening. As I drew nearer I heard a voice:

"Keep back! Keep back!"

A boy came running toward me.

"It's moving!" he said to me as he passed. "It's trying to come out. I don't like it. I'm going home, I am."

I went on to the crowd. There were now two or three hundred people struggling to get a view.

"He's fallen in the pit!" cried someone.

"Keep back!" someone said.

The crowd swayed a little, and I elbowed my way through. Everyone seemed greatly excited. I heard a strange humming sound from the pit.

"I say!" said Ogilvy; "help keep these people back. We don't know what's in the pit!"

The end of a cylinder was being screwed out from within. Nearly two feet of shining screw stuck out of the ground. Someone crashed into me, and I nearly fell onto the top of the screw. I turned, and as I did so the screw must have come out. The lid of the cylinder fell onto the ground with a loud bang. I stuck my elbow into the person behind me, and turned my head toward the Thing again.

I think everyone expected to see a man come out. Maybe something a little unlike us Earth people. But we expected to see a man. I know I did. But, I saw something moving in the shadows, and it was no man. Gray and

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Science Fiction

flowing, one shadow form above another. Then two bright disks that might have been eyes. Then something that looked like a gray snake, it was about as thick as a walking stick. It was coiled up, and now it wriggled in the air toward me. And then came another one. More and more tentacles.

I was now very cold. I was now alone at the edge of the pit. Everyone else had run away. I looked again at the cylinder. I became very afraid.

I saw a gray round form the size of a bear. It was rising slowly out of the cylinder. As it came up and caught the light, it shined like wet leather.

Two large dark eyes looked at me. The head was round and had a sort of face. There was a mouth under the eyes. It dripped spit. The whole creature shook. One of the tentacles gripped the edge of the cylinder. Another swayed in the air. I was overcome with fear.

Part 2

Answer these questions about the story on a separate sheet of paper.

1. Which is the first clue that this story is science fiction?
 - a. The man struggles against a crowd.
 - b. Something strange was coming out of the ground.
 - c. A crowd of people was afraid.
 - d. A man was scared and ran away.
2. Where do you think this story takes place?
3. The creature described in the story exists in real life.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. Make a list of the science fiction details and features in the story.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Science Fiction

Part 3

1. Now think of some ideas for a science fiction story of your own. Try to imagine an interesting invention that would change life as we know it, such as time machine. Or think about what life on another planet might be like. Brainstorm your ideas on a separate sheet of paper.
2. Now write your science fiction story. Make sure to include details about scientific advances or changes to life as we know it today.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Realistic Fiction

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- identify the features of realistic fiction.
- write a realistic fiction story.

Materials

- pens or pencils
- lined paper

Background Information

Realistic fiction is a fictional story about something that could happen in real life. The story isn't actually true, but it seems as though it could be.

Realistic fiction can help you remember something special, like the time you got your first pet. It can also help you imagine what you might do in a difficult situation. Realistic fiction can help you learn about people different from you and places unlike your home.

When you write realistic fiction, you should think of something that happened to you or someone you know that would be interesting to other people. You want to include as many details about what happened, the characters it happened to, and the place where it happened as possible. You want your readers to feel as though they are part of the story, too.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Realistic Fiction

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, read some realistic fiction and answer a few questions about it. Then plan and write your own realistic fiction story.

Part 1

Read the story below.

An Uncovered Mystery

“Keep digging under this rock,” said Jeff quietly.

The two boys were in the backyard of the old McGregor mansion with only a flashlight.

“I’m not so sure about this,” said David nervously.

“I know the box is here,” Jeff whispered. “It’s got gold and jewels in it.”

“This is spooky,” said David, a little frightened. “How did you find out about the box anyway?”

“I heard the story about old man McGregor,” Jeff whispered. “His wife died. Then he died of a broken heart.”

“What about the treasure?” asked David.

“He left a note saying he was too sad to look at his life’s treasures anymore. So he buried them in a box back here. When I find them, I’ll be rich. I’m going to buy all the computer games I want!”

The rock tumbled backward. There was a beautiful black and gold jewelry box. Jeff opened it.

“There’re no jewels here!” cried Jeff. “Only wedding pictures!”

“You were wrong about the treasure,” said David. “These pictures were his life’s treasure, not the jewels.”

“You’re right,” said Jeff a little sad. “The real treasures are in your heart.”

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Realistic Fiction

Part 2

Now answer these questions.

1. Do you think this story could have really happened?
2. Write on your paper the features of the story that make it the most realistic:

the flashlight computer games digging at a mansion
wedding pictures dying of a broken heart
3. The boys learn a lesson at the end.

a. true b. false
4. If you were going to change one thing about this story, what would you change?

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Realistic Fiction

Part 3

Now plan and write your own realistic fiction. Start by thinking of something interesting that happened to you or someone you know. It is okay to write about something that really happened, but you don't have to.

Think of a story that would help someone from a different place understand you and your values. Or write about something that might help a younger kid figure out an answer to a problem. Try to think of something that someone your age would be interested in learning about, or to which he or she could relate.

Remember, it is okay to write about something that actually happened. You may want to change some of the details to make the story more interesting, to help your readers understand a detail, or to help them learn a lesson.

Make a list of the characters, the setting, the main idea, and the climax of the story.

On your paper, brainstorm your ideas for the plot of the story.

You're ready to write your story! On your paper, write a piece of realistic fiction.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Travel Brochure

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- describe the features of a travel brochure.
- identify sensory details.
- write a travel brochure for people who want to visit your hometown.

Materials

- paper
- markers
- crayons

Background Information

A **travel brochure** is a kind of advertisement that people from hotels, different states, and even whole countries make. Travel brochures help people learn about places they want to visit. They describe the best parts of a place, such as parks, beaches, museums, and arts in the area. Travel brochures often have pictures of the most beautiful things to see there, and sometimes contain maps and information about restaurants and other useful tips.

Sensory details are details in any written text that help you imagine how something feels, looks, tastes, smells, or sounds. Travel brochures often use sensory details to help people imagine a place.

Activity

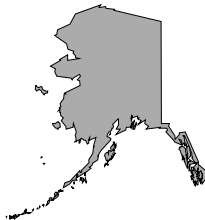
Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

In this lesson you will read and describe a travel brochure and answer some questions about it. Then you will make a travel brochure for your own hometown!

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Travel Brochure

Part 1

Look at the travel brochure below.

Come to Alaska!!  Whether you visit Prince of Wales Island Or Klondike Gold Rush National Park You will never forget your trip to ALASKA! Come see: Breathtaking Views of Snowcapped Mountains Pristine Fishing Waters Colorful Fall Foliage And more!	Backpacking! Ocean Day Cruises! Wildlife Watching! There is so much to experience in Alaska!   Feel the rumble under your feet as a moose runs by. Listen to the roar of a grizzly in the distance.
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Reading for SylvanSync™ Grades 3–5 Travel Brochure

Now answer these questions.

1. Which of these phrases from the travel brochure is an example of a sensory detail?
 - a. There is so much to experience.
 - b. You will never forget your trip to Alaska.
 - c. Feel the rumble under your feet as a moose runs by.
 - d. Backpacking! Ocean day cruises! Wildlife watching!
2. List some of the animals you might see in Alaska.
3. Alaska has national parks.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. On your paper, describe what you might see if you visited Alaska.

Part 2

Think about your hometown. What is your favorite place to visit there? Is there something very beautiful in your town? Does your town have a good museum, library, or historic monument? Are there good restaurants or ice cream shops? What might visitors do if they came there?

On a separate sheet of paper, write a list of a few great attractions or activities in your town.

Part 3

Make a travel brochure of your hometown. Use the details from your list. Describe the places on your list in short sentences. Make sure to include sensory details to help people imagine their visit to your hometown. Draw pictures of the most beautiful places in your town.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 3–5

Comparative Literature

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- compare and contrast a work of fiction and a work of nonfiction that deal with the same subject.
- evaluate the presentation of information in both types of writing.

Materials

- paper
- pens or pencils

Background Information

Fiction is a made up story. **Nonfiction** is informational text about real facts and events. Sometimes you will read a piece of fiction and a piece of nonfiction that are about the same topic. You may be asked to compare and contrast those pieces of writing, and to think about the ways in which information on the same topic is presented differently.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

In this lesson you will read a piece of fiction and a piece of nonfiction, both about cyclones. Then you will answer some questions to compare and contrast them.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Comparative Literature

Part 1

Read this adapted excerpt from *The Wizard of Oz* by L. Frank Baum.

From the far north they heard a low wail of the wind, and Uncle Henry and Dorothy could see where the long grass bowed in waves before the coming storm. There now came a sharp whistling in the air from the south. As they turned their eyes that way, they saw ripples in the grass coming from that direction also.

Suddenly Uncle Henry stood up.

“There’s a cyclone coming, Em,” he called to his wife. “I’ll go look after the animals.” Then he ran toward the sheds where the cows and horses were kept.

Aunt Em dropped her work and came to the door. One glance told her of the danger close at hand.

“Quick, Dorothy!” she screamed. “Run for the cellar!”

Toto jumped out of Dorothy’s arms and hid under the bed, and the girl started to get him. Aunt Em, badly frightened, threw open the trap door in the floor and climbed down the ladder into the small, dark cellar. Dorothy caught Toto at last and started to follow her aunt. When she was halfway across the room there came a great shriek from the wind, and the house shook so hard that she lost her footing and fell down upon the floor.

Then a strange thing happened.

The house whirled around two or three times and rose slowly through the air. Dorothy felt as if she were going up in a balloon.

The north and south winds met where the house stood, and made it the exact center of the cyclone. In the middle of a cyclone the air is generally still, but the great pressure of the wind on every side of the house raised it up higher and higher, until it was at the very top of the cyclone; and there it remained and was carried miles and miles away as easily as you could carry a feather.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Comparative Literature

It was very dark, and the wind howled horribly around her, but Dorothy found she was riding quite easily. After the first few whirls around, and one other time when the house tipped badly, she felt as if she were being rocked gently, like a baby in a cradle.

Toto did not like it. He ran about the room, barking loudly, but Dorothy sat quite still on the floor and waited to see what would happen.

Once Toto got too near the open trap door, and fell in; and at first the little girl thought she had lost him. But soon she saw one of his ears sticking up through the hole, for the strong pressure of the air was keeping him up so that he could not fall. She crept to the hole, caught Toto by the ear, and dragged him into the room again, afterward closing the trap door so that no more accidents could happen.

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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Comparative Literature

Part 2

Read this article about cyclones.

Tornadoes are dangerous storms. They are sometimes called “cyclones” or “twisters.” These words describe the same kind of storm. A tornado is a spinning column of air. It forms on the base of some clouds. Most tornadoes are shaped like a funnel. The narrow end touches the earth. When the column of air touches the ground, it can cause a lot of damage.

The wind speed in most tornadoes is less than 110 miles per hour. The column of air is about 250 feet across. These tornadoes touch down on the ground and travel a few miles. Then they break up and disappear. But there have been extreme tornadoes. The wind speed inside some cyclones has reached more than 300 miles per hour. The column of air was more than two miles across! Storms like that cause much more damage on the ground.

Tornadoes can happen almost anywhere on Earth. But most happen in a part of the United States called Tornado Alley. In that area, the land is very flat, and the winds are strong even on a clear day. Storm clouds can cause tornadoes there. When that happens, people have to be careful. People who live in Tornado Alley know what to do. There are automatic warning systems in place. Most people have radios that turn on automatically when there is a tornado watch. Then people take shelter in their basements and wait until the storm passes.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 3–5
Comparative Literature

Part 3

Answer these questions to compare and contrast the texts you just read.

1. Which best describes the excerpt from *The Wizard of Oz*?
 - a. a text that provides facts and details about tornadoes
 - b. a realistic story that describes living through a tornado
 - c. a story describing things a tornado could not do in real life
 - d. a story that tells about the history of tornadoes
2. In which book might you read the article about cyclones?
 - a. a collection of short fiction
 - b. an encyclopedia of weather
3. A cyclone could lift up your house and drop you into a different land.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. A cyclone could cause damage to the land over which it runs.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. On your paper, make a list of similarities and differences between the two texts about cyclones.
6. Now write a short essay that compares the text. Make sure to answer these questions:
 - How does *The Wizard of Oz* make you feel about cyclones?
 - How does the article make you feel?
 - What examples from each text support your ideas?